HHH-S-616c
SEPTEMBER 16, 1957
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. HHH-S-00616b (AGR.-AMS)
March 6, 1957, and
Fed. Spec. HHH-S-616a
October 28, 1941

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SPINACH PLANTS, FRESH

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Types.—Spinach plants shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1).

Savoyed or crinkled-leaved
Smooth or flat-leaved

1.2 Grades.—Spinach plants shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.1).

No. 1 (see 3.2.1)
Commercial (see 3.2.2)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications. — There are no other specifications applicable to this specification.

2.2 Standards.—The following standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military standards, required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

2.3 Other publications. — The following documents form a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

United States Standards for Spinach Plants.

(Single copies of the United States Standards for Spinach Plants may be obtained without charge from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.—All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.2 Description of grades.—Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation of requirements (descriptive terms) contained in 3.2.1 and 3.2.2 shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Spinach Plants in effect on date of invitation for bids.

3.2.1 *No. 1* — No. 1 consists of spinach plants of similar varietal characteristics which are well grown, fresh, fairly clean, well trimmed, and which are free from decay, and free from damage caused by coarse stalks or seed stems, discoloration, foreign material, second growth, freezing, disease, insects or mechanical or other means. Not more than a total of 10 percent, by weight, of the spinach plants in any lot may fail to meet the requirements of the grade: Provided, that not more than one-half of this amount, or 5 percent, shall be allowed for serious damage, including therein not more than 1 percent for decay.

3.2.2 *Commercial.*—Commercial consists of spinach plants which meet all the requirements for No. 1 grade except that the spinach plants need only be free from damage by dirt and except for the increased tolerances specified in this section. Not more than a total of 20 percent, by weight, of the spinach plants in any lot may fail to meet the requirements of the grade: Provided, that not more than one-half of this amount, or 10 percent, shall be allowed for serious damage, including therein not more than 1 percent for decay.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Samples of spinach plants offered under this specification may be selected by the Government inspector, examined, and tested at any time to determine if they are in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.*—Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the packing house, both during and after packing, at any suitable point in transit and/or after delivery to the point of destination. If inspection is made during the time of packing, the passing as satisfactory of any detail of packing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.2 *Final inspection.* — Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.3 and 6.4).

4.2.3 *USDA certificate of quality and condition.* — When specified by the procuring agency the contractor shall furnish a U. S. Department of Agriculture, Federal or Federal-State certificate of quality and condition as outlined in procurement documents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* — Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of invitation for bids, or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

The definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

5.1 Packaging, Level C.—Unless otherwise specified, commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 Packing, Level C.—Unless otherwise specified, spinach plants shall be packed in commercial baskets or crates which shall be clean, sound, well filled, and securely covered, and so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order. Each container shall be packed so that the spinach plants in the shown face shall be reasonably representative in size, color, and quality of the contents of the container. Incident to packing, as herein defined, not more than 5 percent of the units may fail to meet the foregoing requirements: Provided, that no individual requirement shall be deliberately disregarded.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*

5.3.1.1 *Labeling.* — Any commercial labeling or additional labeling, as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

5.3.1.2 *Marking for shipment.* — Unless otherwise specified, marking shall be in accordance with good commercial practice.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Labeling.* — Labeling in accordance with 5.3.1.1 will be acceptable.

5.3.2.2 *Marking of shipping containers.* — Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. — Procurement documents should specify the type and grade of product and style of packaging desired, and should specify any limitations on percentage of decay and other such factors which will be acceptable.

6.2 If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Contractor's inspection. — The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.4 Destination inspection.—When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—Q M
Navy—S MC
Air Force.

☆ U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1967

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.